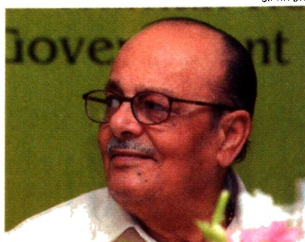
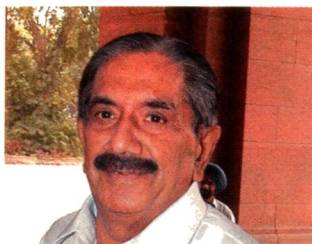


RAVI SAHANI



SIPRA DAS



SIPRA DAS



NARENDRA BISHT

The Writers Bloc

DELHI Politicians are known for their gift of the gab. It was Mani Shankar Aiyar, Congressman-turned-columnist, who once remarked that he needed 500 words just to clear his throat. After rewriting history books, HRD Minister Arjun Singh is currently working on his autobiography. The working title for the book is *A Grain of Sand In The Hourglass of Time*.

As humble as the title is meant to sound, this particular grain of sand has put in many momentous moments in the

hourglass of time including Singh's role in the 1986 Rajiv Gandhi-Longowal accord; his stint as chief minister of Madhya Pradesh and his fractious rapport with Congress presidents Narasimha Rao and Sitaram Kesri. The law graduate is known to choose his words carefully and even corrects the notings on his ministerial files if not drafted right. One hopes his penchant for writing letters will add the requisite colour to his memoirs.

Commerce Minister

PEN DRIVE: (Clockwise) Nath, Arjun, Digvijay and Dhawan

Kamal Nath too is debuting on the literary stage. In between signing global trade agreements, Nath is penning a book on India's economic growth—though given his high-flying lifestyle and smart one-liners, his autobiography might make a more riveting read.

Another Congressman-turned-economist, Digvijay Singh, has the title of his book ready and now just has to work on the rest of it. Called *The People Are the Solution*, the former chief minister will explain how human beings are the ultimate assets and not mere votebanks.

R.K. Dhawan and Mohsina Kidwai are penning their memoirs about the Indira Gandhi era. A loyal Gandhi family aide since 1962, Dhawan says that his book will "reveal all". So it's not just BJP leaders who are dominating the literary world. One wonders if Jaswant Singh's mole will resurface in any of these tales.

by Priya Sahgal

SIGNPOSTS

SUSPENDED: By The Supreme Court Bar Association, advocates **R.K. Anand** and **I.U. Khan**, who were caught on camera allegedly influencing a witness in the Sanjeev Nanda BMW case.



NARENDRA BISHT

APPOINTED: Lok Sabha Speaker **Somnath Chatterjee** as the head of

the South Asia Parliamentary Commission which will have four members from each SAARC country.

AWARDED: To Brazilian President **Luiz Inacio Lula Da Silva**, the Jawaharlal Nehru Award for International Understanding in recognition of his commitment to the eradication of poverty and hunger, by the Indian Council for Cultural Relations.

APPOINTED: **S.K. Shingal**, a 1970-batch IRS officer, as the chairman of Central Board of Excise and Customs.

VIS-A-VIS J. JAYALALITHAA AIADMK chief versus M. KARUNANIDHI DMK chief

“Power has gone to his head. He is behaving like Hitler. Even at 84 he has not mellowed down. I'll wipe out the DMK.”



SAURABH SINGH

“The AIADMK office got a demolition notice by chance and she is making a hue and cry about it.”

EPILOGUE: In Tamil Nadu, every political action is followed by an over-reaction.